

The Crime Busters

A recent study in UK has revealed that almost every murder inquiry has ended up using some kind of footage from a CCTV as evidence.

eventuality we need to stop burglars from gaining entry. That is where electronic devices such as magnetic sensors, glass break detectors and microwave motion detectors, come in. These are efficient in foiling intrusion attempts. The Microwave Motion Detector uses sophisticated technology to detect human body movement within the range of a protected area. The digital processing used in this system ensures high level of immunity from false alarms. In case of an intrusion, a loud hooter (enough to be heard in the entire building), will go off. If such an arrangement is in place, alerts are sent to a 24/7 monitoring station and in the form of SMS to the subscribed numbers.

Another interesting item for home security is the CCTV system. This system of two-way communication is a great tool for viewing and interacting with any visitor without having to open the door. You can observe suspicious movements outside your door by activating the camera through the indoor unit. The system comes in many different models from which the user can choose after taking into consideration the budget and safety requirements of a house. For safety from fire related hazards, you can also opt for smoke detectors and the gas leak detectors. However, smoke detectors may not be useful in a house where people smoke as cigarette smoke is notoriously prone to triggering the system. All electronic security systems must draw their power through the grid, so somewhere down the line there's going to be an addition to electricity bills.

Residents in high-rise buildings can go in for a product, which in the lexicon of electronic surveillance is known as multi-apartment video door phone. The main advantage of this system is that it provides two layers of security - the first at the building's gate, and the second at the resident's door. The system envisages a panel at the main gate of the building that has a keypad on which any visitor has to press the number of the apartment he intends to visit. This will lead to a chime in the home unit of the desired apartment. The main advantage of this system is that it performs the task of a watchman. You don't have to

INTERVIEW

Interview with Anand Swaminathan, Director, Zicom Retails

What kind security system do you think a normal middle class home needs to install?

There are two types of security systems for a household namely - Home Alarm System and Video Door phone. While Video Door Phone is a stand-alone system to detect and prevent intrusion; 'Home Alarm System' is a holistic system, which protects a household on the parameters of intrusion, motion, glass break, fire and gas leak. In case an event is detected by the system, then the Hooter will start sounding an alarm.



How difficult is it to use and maintain such security systems?

It is not difficult at all to use these security systems, which come with user-friendly applications that are easy to operate. Like any other electronic items, they are susceptible to dust, moisture etc. so if proper care is taken and regular upkeep is maintained, then the system will keep on giving good service. Plus, Zicom also has an online trouble-shooting centre, where a user can get any query answered.

Tell us about your best-selling home security systems?

Video Door Phone is our best-selling home security system. This system gives you the ability to peep out of the front door from any room of the house and interact with the visitor without opening the door. We have an extensive range of aesthetically designed and elegant looking Video Door Phones to suit every buyer's need. The product range consists of Black & White with Handset, Black & White Hands free, Large Screen Colour Handsfree, and Large Screen Colour Handsfree with Photoframe.

What initiatives are you taking to bring about growth in your company?

We are focussing on penetrating deeper into the market. We plan to appoint 5000 dealers in the next 2-3 years. Our plan envisages a focus on corporate and institutional segment, where the business potential is very high. Recently we have put in place a direct sales team, which will exclusively focus on the builders and architects vertical.

Who is your main competitor in India?

Competition is getting hotter by the day, especially in the corporate segment. But the good news is that now we are seeing branded entrants in this market and so there is a level playing field unlike in the past, when we were having competition from unbranded Made in China products.

hire extra security personnel either, and the building saves money that it would normally pay as watchman's salary. When a visitor arrives at the gate, and he presses the number of the apartment, the owner of that apartment will be able to talk to the visitor via intercom and verify their identity. After that the owner presses a button in the interface while in the apartment to open the main gate.

As most of these systems are powered by rechargeable batteries, they're not affected by power cuts. However, once the systems are installed in their homes, home owners have to ensure that the

rechargeable batteries are working in perfect order. The most common mistake that people make is that they don't take maintenance too seriously. There could also be dispute between different members of the society over who would actually foot the bill for a system such as a multi-apartment video door phone. But if installed properly, and maintained at regular intervals, such a system can definitely add to the sense of security.

Car Security

In USA, a car is stolen every 26 seconds, and in urban India the trend is